

Daily Shipping Trade Advisory — Sattva Global Logistics

Date: 12 May 2026, 3:00 PM IST | **Website:** sattvaglobal.in/trade-advisory

Executive Summary

As of the 3:00 PM IST update on 12 May 2026, three material developments are shaping Indian export freight markets. The Strait of Hormuz remains severely disrupted following the Iran conflict that began in early March 2026, with Maersk vessel contingency pages (last updated 5 May 2026) showing multiple vessels on India-Gulf strings rerouted or carrying extended ETAs; Bahrain port operations are suspended, Oman Salalah is suspended, and Kuwait Shuaiba is only partially resumed, while Jebel Ali, Dammam, Jubail, Doha, and Sohar remain open. Second, Maersk has issued a Peak Season Surcharge (PSS) from Indian Subcontinent and Middle East to US East Coast and Gulf effective 10 June 2026, ranging USD 1,500 to 1,800 per container depending on origin port — announced 11 May 2026. Third, also on 11 May, Maersk has reduced its Emergency Contingency Surcharge (ECS) from Indian Subcontinent to North Europe and Mediterranean effective 15 May 2026, cutting 40DRY rates by USD 300 per box for South and East India origins. CMA CGM's revised Emergency Fuel Surcharge from India Subcontinent to the US at USD 265/TEU and USD 530/FEU took effect 1 May 2026. Hapag-Lloyd has announced a GRI of USD 1,000 per container from Indian Subcontinent and Middle East to North America effective 1 June 2026.

Key Developments Today

- **Strait of Hormuz (ongoing since early Mar 2026):** Severe disruption continues. Bahrain and Oman Salalah port services suspended. Kuwait Shuaiba partially resumed. Multiple Maersk vessels on India-Gulf routes showing rerouted or extended ETAs as of 5 May 2026. Gulf-bound Indian exporters face unpredictable schedules and elevated surcharge exposure.
 - **Maersk PSS — ISC to US East Coast & Gulf (eff. 10 Jun 2026):** USD 1,500–1,800/container depending on origin (announced 11 May 2026). Non-SPOT bookings only. NW India (JNPT/Mundra) rates set at USD 1,650; South & East India at USD 1,500; USHOU-bound at USD 1,800.
 - **Maersk ECS Reduction — ISC to North Europe & Mediterranean (eff. 15 May 2026):** South & East India 40DRY drops from USD 1,200 to USD 900; 20DRY from USD 1,100 to USD 800. Bangladesh 40DRY drops from USD 1,600 to USD 1,300. Effective PCD 15 May 2026.
 - **CMA CGM EFS — ISC to US (eff. 1 May 2026):** Dry USD 265/TEU | USD 530/FEU. Reefer USD 180/TEU | USD 360/FEU. Applicable until further notice.
 - **Hapag-Lloyd GRI — ISC & Middle East to North America (eff. 1 Jun 2026):** USD 1,000/container all sizes. All coasts. Applies to all containers gated in full from 1 June 2026.
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Carrier-Specific Updates

Maersk — Status: DISRUPTED

Maersk issued a Peak Season Surcharge (PSS) on 11 May 2026 for Indian Subcontinent and Middle East to US East Coast and Gulf, effective from Price Calculation Date 10 June 2026. Rates range USD 1,500/container (South and East India to all US/Canada E+G PODs except Houston) to USD 1,800/container (India/Bangladesh/Sri Lanka/Maldives to USHOU). On the same date, Maersk reduced its Emergency Contingency Surcharge (ECS) for Indian Subcontinent to North Europe and Mediterranean trades effective PCD 15 May 2026 — South and East India 40DRY drops from USD 1,200 to USD 900; 20DRY from USD 1,100 to USD 800. Vessel contingency pages (updated 5 May 2026) show active rerouting across India-Gulf and India-Africa services due to the Strait of Hormuz situation, with numerous vessels showing revised ETAs through mid-May. Gulf port status: Bahrain suspended; Oman Salalah suspended; Kuwait Shuaiba partially resumed; Jebel Ali, Dammam, Jubail, Doha, Sohar Duqm open.

CMA CGM — Status: DISRUPTED

CMA CGM issued a revised Emergency Fuel Surcharge (EFS/BAF09) on 28 April 2026 effective 1 May 2026, applicable to India Subcontinent exports to US East Coast, Gulf Coast, and West Coast. Dry container rates: USD 265/20-foot, USD 530/40-foot and 40HC and 45HC. Reefer rates: USD 180/20-foot, USD 360/40-foot. The surcharge is tied to ongoing bunker cost increases driven by Middle East geopolitical tensions and applies until further notice.

Hapag-Lloyd — Status: NORMAL (Surcharge Active)

Hapag-Lloyd has announced a General Rate Increase (GRI/GRA) of USD 1,000/container for shipments from the Indian Subcontinent, Pakistan, and the Middle East to North America (US and Canada, all coasts), effective for all containers gated in full from 1 June 2026. Applies to 20-foot and 40-foot dry, reefer, and special containers including high cube equipment.

Surcharge Table

Carrier	Surcharge Name	Trade Lane	Effective Date	Amount (TEU/20')	Amount (FEU/40')	Currency	Source
Maersk	PSS	S & E India → US East & Gulf (excl. USHOU)	10 Jun 2026	USD 1,500	USD 1,500	USD	maersk.com
Maersk	PSS	NW India/Nepal/Bhutan → US East & Gulf (excl. USHOU)	10 Jun 2026	USD 1,650	USD 1,650	USD	maersk.com
Maersk	PSS	India/Bangladesh/Sri Lanka/Maldives → USHOU	10 Jun 2026	USD 1,800	USD 1,800	USD	maersk.com
Maersk	ECS (reduced)	S & E India / Sri Lanka / Maldives → N. Europe (E3W) & Med (E4W)	15 May 2026	USD 800 (was 1,100)	USD 900 (was 1,200)	USD	maersk.com
Maersk	ECS (reduced)	Bangladesh → N. Europe (E3W) & Med (E4W)	15 May 2026	USD 1,000 (was 1,300)	USD 1,300 (was 1,600)	USD	maersk.com
CMA CGM	EFS (BAF09)	India Subcontinent → US East / Gulf / West Coast	01 May 2026	USD 265 (Dry) / 180 (Reefer)	USD 530 (Dry) / 360 (Reefer)	USD	cma-cgm.com
Hapag-Lloyd	GRI/GRA	ISC & Middle East → North America (all coasts)	01 Jun 2026	USD 1,000	USD 1,000	USD	hapag-lloyd.com

Trade Impact on Indian Exporters

Exporters shipping FCL to Gulf destinations (UAE, Saudi Arabia, Qatar, Kuwait, Oman, Bahrain, Iraq) face the highest operational risk right now. The Strait of Hormuz disruption since early March 2026 means feeder connectivity to Gulf ports is impaired — Bahrain is suspended, Oman Salalah is suspended, and services to Jebel Ali, Dammam, and Qatar remain open but with extended and unpredictable schedules. Exporters from JNPT, Mundra, Pipavav, and Hazira should check vessel contingency pages with their carrier before confirming bookings and build in schedule buffer of at least two to three weeks versus pre-crisis transit times.

For US-bound cargo, exporters face compounding surcharges from June: Maersk PSS at USD 1,500–1,800/container from 10 June, plus Hapag-Lloyd GRI at USD 1,000/container from 1 June — NW India exporters shipping via Mundra and JNPT to the US East Coast should urgently cost this into their landed price quotes to American buyers.

Exporters to North Europe and Mediterranean on Maersk services get modest relief from the ECS reduction effective 15 May — a saving of USD 300 per 40DRY box for South and East India origins.

All exporters should request updated all-in surcharge quotations from their freight forwarder before finalising any new sales contracts with overseas buyers, and Gulf-cargo shippers should verify that their marine insurance covers current Hormuz war risk.

Recommended Contingency Actions

1. **Gulf-bound exporters:** Confirm vessel status and contingency ETA with your carrier or freight forwarder before gating in cargo. Do not rely on pre-crisis transit time benchmarks — add 2–3 weeks buffer minimum.
2. **US-bound exporters (all origins):** Requote your landed cost to US/Canadian buyers immediately to account for the Hapag-Lloyd GRI (effective 1 Jun) and Maersk PSS (effective 10 Jun). Both carriers now add USD 1,000–1,800/box on top of base freight.
3. **Europe/Med exporters (Maersk):** Ensure your booking is priced against the new (lower) ECS rates from PCD 15 May — request updated quotes if you have outstanding non-spot bookings.
4. **War risk insurance:** Confirm with your marine insurer that Gulf/Hormuz war risk is covered under your current cargo policy. Rates and exclusions have changed materially since March 2026.
5. **Booking lead times:** All major services are experiencing schedule disruptions. Book 2–3 weeks earlier than usual for any June shipment, particularly for US and Gulf destinations.

Sources Referenced

- Maersk Rate Advisory, 11 May 2026 — PSS ISC & ME to US East & Gulf: maersk.com/news/articles/2026/05/11/pss-isc-middle-east-to-us-east-gulf
- Maersk ECS Advisory, 11 May 2026 — ECS reduction ISC to N. Europe & Mediterranean: maersk.com/news/articles/2026/05/11/change-to-ecs-indian-subcontinent-to-north-europe-mediterranean
- Maersk Vessel Contingency Updates, last updated 5 May 2026: maersk.com/news/articles/2026/03/03/middle-east-vessel-contingency-updates
- Maersk Middle East Port Operations, last updated 5 May 2026: maersk.com/news/articles/2026/03/04/situation-middle-east-port-operation-updates
- CMA CGM Emergency Fuel Surcharge Advisory (BAF09), 28 April 2026: cma-cgm.com/local/pakistan/news/465
- Hapag-Lloyd GRI — ISC & Middle East to North America: container-news.com/hapag-lloyd-introduces-new-rates-from-indian-sub-and-middle-east-to-north-america
- Container News
- UANI Iran War Shipping Tracker (May 2026): unitedagainstnucleariran.com
- 2026 Strait of Hormuz Crisis context: Wikipedia, Al Jazeera, Washington Times

This advisory is prepared by Sattva Global Logistics for informational purposes. Exporters should verify all surcharge amounts and routing details directly with their carrier or freight forwarder before committing to bookings. Surcharge rates are subject to regulatory approvals and may change at short notice.

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